

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1007

By Keisling

A RESOLUTION to honor Darrell Collins upon his induction into the Clay County Sports Hall of Fame.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that this General Assembly pay tribute to those gifted athletes, coaches, administrators, and contributors who attained the very pinnacle of sporting achievement; and

WHEREAS, Darrell Collins is one such legendary contributor, who was recently inducted into the Clay County Sports Hall of Fame; and

WHEREAS, an iconic figure within the annals of Clay County sports, Mr. Collins has lived his entire life as a diehard Bulldog player, fan, announcer, and coach, having a profound impact on his beloved community; and

WHEREAS, after playing baseball and football for two years, Darrell Collins suffered an injury that left him physically unable to participate as a traditional athlete. Unwilling to allow his circumstances to hinder his contributions, he turned to public address announcing and coaching; and

WHEREAS, accepting the role of full-time announcer for Celina High School, Mr. Collins became known as the "Voice of the Bulldogs" at Celina football and basketball games, creating a unique homefield and home-court advantage for the Dawgs with his special brand of charisma, music, and enthusiasm; and

WHEREAS, Darrell Collins also sang the national anthem at events and won acclaim as a master of his craft, often hired to serve as the announcer for district and region basketball tournaments; and

WHEREAS, he also spent many years as a coach for youth teams in multiple sports in Clay County, including Little League baseball (State Farm Reds), Babe Ruth baseball (Celina

Rebels), and AAU girls' basketball (Lady Rockets), and was a co-founder of the youth football league; and

WHEREAS, Darrell Collins has demonstrated leadership, skill, and community spirit throughout his career, and it is fitting that we should honor him on this special occasion; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor Darrell Collins upon his induction into the Clay County Sports Hall of Fame and extend to him our best wishes for much continued success in all his future endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.